

IT Access and Usage Policy

Sample operational policy with intentional control gaps for analyzer testing

Field	Value
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1. Purpose

This policy establishes baseline expectations for how employees, contractors, and temporary personnel access and use organizational systems, networks, software, and devices. The intent is to support business operations while reducing the likelihood of avoidable misuse, service interruptions, and exposure of company information.

The organization relies on a practical and trust-based model of access. Personnel are expected to use sound judgment, to use company systems primarily for legitimate business activity, and to consult their manager or Information Technology when uncertain about an acceptable course of action.

2. Scope

This policy applies to company-managed laptops, desktops, mobile devices, network accounts, collaboration tools, shared drives, email systems, and cloud applications that are provided or approved by the organization.

The policy also applies to third parties who are given access to company systems to perform contracted work. Business units may maintain local procedures that complement this document where operationally necessary.

3. User Access Principles

Access should be granted according to a user's role and normal business responsibilities. Managers are expected to request the access their team members need, and Information Technology will provision accounts in a timely manner.

Users should not attempt to access systems or data outside the areas they ordinarily use. When access appears unnecessary or unusual, the matter should be discussed with the manager before a request is made.

- Shared accounts should be avoided where practical.
- Privileged access may be assigned to technical personnel where job duties require it.
- Users should keep their credentials confidential and should not lend devices to unauthorized individuals.

4. Acceptable Use

Company technology resources are provided to support business operations. Limited personal use is permitted when it does not interfere with work, create excessive load on company systems, or conflict with law or company values.

Users must not use company technology to harass others, engage in unlawful conduct, distribute offensive material, or intentionally bypass technical safeguards established by the organization.

Software should be installed through approved channels where practical. Employees who need new tools for productivity should consult Information Technology or their manager.

5. Authentication and Passwords

Users are expected to maintain reasonably strong passwords and to protect them from unauthorized disclosure. Passwords should not be obvious, should not be reused carelessly, and should be changed when compromise is suspected.

Additional authentication measures may be required for some systems depending on operational needs or system capabilities.

6. Devices, Remote Work, and Connectivity

Personnel working remotely should take appropriate care with company devices and should avoid leaving equipment unattended in insecure locations. Company devices should be connected to the internet regularly so that updates and normal maintenance activities can occur.

Use of public or shared networks should be approached carefully. Where a connection seems untrustworthy, users should delay sensitive activity or seek guidance from Information Technology.

- Devices should be locked when not in active use.
- Users should report loss or theft of equipment promptly.
- External storage devices should be used only where necessary.

7. Monitoring and Privacy

The organization may monitor systems, network traffic, and technology assets to protect operations, investigate misuse, and support troubleshooting. Users should not assume that activity performed on company-owned systems is entirely private.

Monitoring activities will be conducted in a manner appropriate to business needs.

8. Incident Reporting and Exceptions

Users should notify the service desk or their manager if they suspect phishing, unauthorized access, malware, or any other event that may affect company systems.

Exceptions to this policy may be approved by management and Information Technology where justified by business requirements.

9. Enforcement

Violations of this policy may result in corrective action, restriction of access, or other measures the organization considers appropriate based on the circumstances.